

Task 1 — Install antispyware and perform a full scan

Step 1: Install Malwarebytes

- Download it from the official Malwarebytes website:
 - [Malwarebytes official website](#)
- Install it normally.

Step 2: Run a scan

1. Open Malwarebytes.
2. Go to Scanner.
3. Select Threat Scan.
4. Start the scan.
5. Wait until it finishes.
6. If threats are detected, quarantine them only if they are actually unwanted/malicious.

Task 2 — Five signs of possible spyware infection

No.	Possible sign	Explanation
1	Phone becomes unusually slow	Spyware/malware may consume CPU, RAM or other resources in the background.
2	Battery drains unusually quickly	Malicious background processes can continuously use CPU, network or location services.
3	Unexpected apps appear	Malware can install additional applications or disguise itself as a legitimate utility.
4	Unusually high mobile-data usage	Spyware may send collected information to a remote server.
5	Unexpected microphone/camera/location activity	Advanced spyware can abuse device sensors and surveillance capabilities.

Real-world examples

- Pegasus: Indian Express reported in April 2025 that court documents indicated approximately 100 Indians were among people targeted in the 2019 WhatsApp Pegasus campaign.
- Landfall: A 2025 report described Landfall spyware targeting Samsung Galaxy devices and noted capabilities involving device data, microphone access and location tracking.
- Operation NoVoice: In April 2026, Times of India reported on more than 50 malicious Android apps that had collectively been downloaded more than 2.3 million times before removal. The apps reportedly appeared legitimate while hiding malicious functionality.
- Pegasus/WhatsApp: In July 2026, Indian Express reported on a Pegasus-related campaign involving malicious links sent through WhatsApp.

Task 3 — Simulate browser spyware

Create:

- spyware_simulation.html

```
<!DOCTYPE html>

<html>

<head>
  <title>Spyware Simulation</title>

  <style>
    body {
      font-family: Arial, sans-serif;
      background: #f2f2f2;
      text-align: center;
      padding-top: 100px;
    }
  }

```

```
.login-box {
  background: white;
  width: 320px;
  margin: auto;
  padding: 30px;
  border-radius: 10px;
  box-shadow: 0 0 10px #aaa;
}

input {
  width: 90%;
  padding: 10px;
  margin: 8px;
}

button {
  padding: 10px 20px;
  background: #d62976;
  color: white;
  border: none;
  border-radius: 5px;
}
</style>
</head>

<body>

<div class="login-box">

  <h2>Instagram Login Simulation</h2>

  <input type="text" placeholder="Username">

  <input
```

```
        type="password"
        id="password"
        placeholder="Password"
    >

    <br>

    <button>Login with Instagram</button>

</div>

<script>

const passwordField = document.getElementById("password");

passwordField.addEventListener("input", function () {

    console.log("Captured input:", passwordField.value);

});

</script>

</body>
</html>
```

How to test it

1. Save the file as spyware_simulation.html.
2. Open it in Chrome/Edge.
3. Press:
 - F12 → Console
4. Click the password field.
5. Type something such as:
 - Test123
6. You will see the value appearing in the Console.

Task 4 — Windows Defender vs Malwarebytes

Feature	Windows Defender	Malwarebytes
Detection methods	Signatures, behavioral detection, cloud-based protection and machine-learning techniques	Malware signatures, behavioral detection and additional anti-malware technologies
Real-time protection	Yes, when Microsoft Defender Antivirus is active	Real-time protection is available with paid/Premium protection; the Free version is primarily for manual scanning
Updates	Security intelligence updates are delivered regularly through Microsoft	Malware database/software updates are delivered regularly
Ransomware protection	Yes, including Controlled Folder Access	Yes, depending on edition/configuration
Browser protection	Microsoft Defender SmartScreen helps protect against malicious websites/downloads	Malwarebytes provides web/browser protection features depending on edition
Cost	Built into Windows	Free scanner available; additional protection requires a paid plan
User interface	Integrated into Windows Security	Dedicated Malwarebytes application
Best use	Everyday baseline protection	Additional malware/spyware scanning and second-opinion scanning

Task 5 — Smartphone spyware prevention checklist

Spyware Prevention Checklist

1. Install applications only from official app stores.
 - Use Google Play Store or Apple's App Store whenever possible.
2. Keep the operating system updated.
 - Install Android/iOS security updates promptly.
3. Keep applications updated.
 - Updates frequently contain security fixes.
4. Avoid unknown APK files.
 - Do not install applications received through suspicious WhatsApp messages, Telegram, websites or unknown links.
5. Review application permissions.
 - Check whether an app really needs access to your microphone, camera, contacts, SMS, location or files.
6. Use a strong screen lock.
 - Use a strong PIN/password or biometric authentication.
7. Do not share your phone's PIN or account passwords.
 - Physical access to an unlocked phone can make installation of stalkerware much easier.
8. Enable Google Play Protect on Android.
9. Avoid suspicious links.
 - Especially links received through unexpected SMS, email or messaging-app conversations.
10. Monitor unusual battery and data consumption.
 - Unexpected changes can be a reason to investigate installed applications.
11. Remove applications you don't recognize.
 - Periodically review your installed-app list.
12. Use multi-factor authentication.
 - MFA provides another security layer if a password is compromised.

Two practices I would implement on my own smartphone

1. Avoid unknown APK files

- I would install applications only from the Google Play Store and avoid APK files received through WhatsApp, Telegram, SMS or random websites.
- If someone sends me an APK and asks me to install it, I would first verify the application's developer and source instead of installing it directly.
- This is particularly important because recent reporting has highlighted malicious Android applications and harmful APK-based attacks.

2. Regularly check application permissions

I would periodically open:

- Settings → Apps → App permissions

and check access to:

- Camera
- Microphone
- Location
- Contacts
- SMS
- Files/photos